

Ceratophrys cornuta

Surinam horned frog



Location N.W. South America

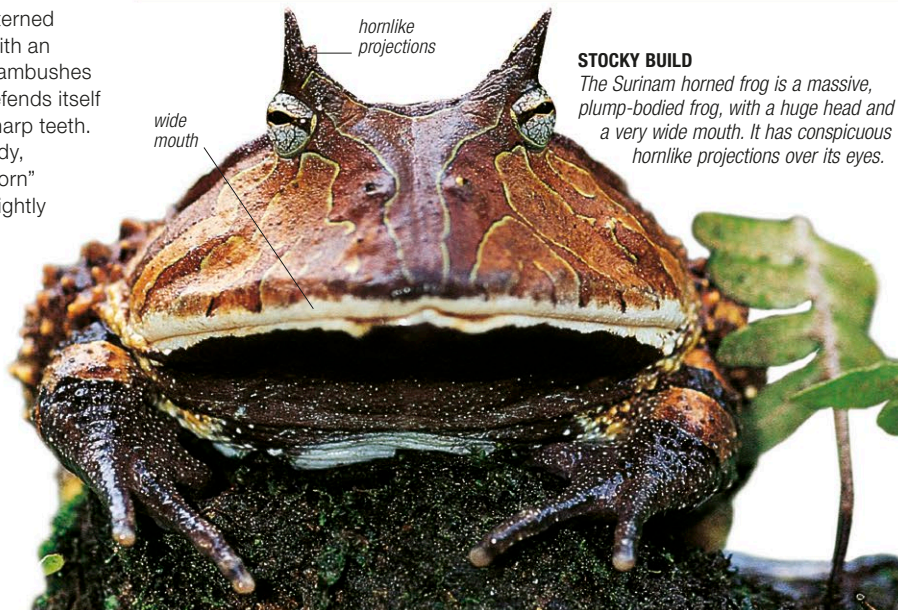


Length 4–8 in (10–20 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
Status Least concern

This bulky and intricately patterned frog is a formidable hunter, with an exceptionally large mouth. It ambushes its prey and, if threatened, defends itself ferociously, using its large, sharp teeth. It has a well-camouflaged body, relatively short legs, and a “horn” above each eye. Males are slightly smaller than females and, in the breeding season, they produce a mating call that sounds like cattle lowing. Females lay up to 1,000 eggs, wrapped around aquatic plants. Unlike most tadpoles, Surinam horned frog tadpoles are predatory from the moment they hatch, and attack the tadpoles of other frogs and even each other. They have large, horny beaks and muscular jaws.

HUNTING BY AMBUSH

The Surinam horned frog catches other frogs, lizards, and mice using a sit-and-wait technique. It partly buries itself in soft ground, sometimes with only its eyes projecting above the surface, and then waits for animals to pass by. Like other amphibians, it is triggered into action by movement. Once its prey is within range, it bursts out of hiding, immobilizes its victim with its fangs, and then swallows it whole.



STOCKY BUILD

The Surinam horned frog is a massive, plump-bodied frog, with a huge head and a very wide mouth. It has conspicuous hornlike projections over its eyes.

Telmatobius culeus

Titicaca water frog

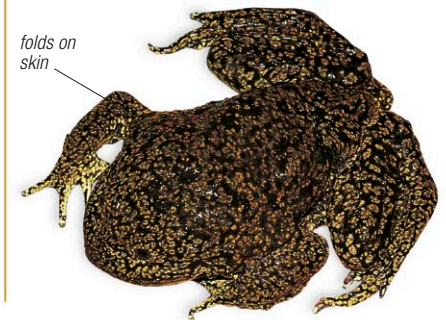


Location South America (Lake Titicaca)



Length 3¼–4¼ in (8–12 cm)
Habit Wholly aquatic
Breeding Summer season
Status Critically endangered

This frog has several adaptations that suit it to a life in the cold, oxygen-impooverished waters of Lake Titicaca. It has long hind legs with fully webbed hind feet for swimming, and very small lungs that enable it to dive. Due to the small size of its lungs, it relies mainly on oxygen taken in through the skin. This uptake is increased by the extensive folds in its skin, which increase the animal's surface area, and the presence of numerous blood vessels and red blood cells.

*Eupemphix nattereri*

Cuyaba dwarf frog



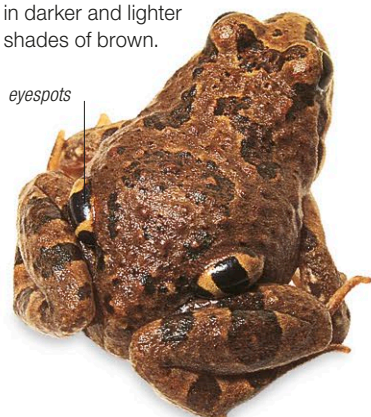
Location E. South America



Length 1¼–1½ in (3–4 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding After heavy rain season
Status Least concern

The Cuyaba dwarf frog is characterized by the 2 black and white eyespots on its rear. When threatened, it inflates its body and lifts up its rear end, displaying these false eyes to startle the predator. It can also secrete a distasteful substance from glands near its groin to further deter its attacker. This frog has a plump, toadlike body, with short limbs. It is mid-brown, with marbled patterning in darker and lighter shades of brown.

eyespot

*Engystomops pustulosus*

Tungara frog



Location Central America, N.W. South America



Length 1¼–1½ in (3–4 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
Status Least concern

warty skin



With its dark gray or brown warty skin, this Central American frog resembles a toad. The male calls loudly to attract females, repeatedly inflating his large vocal sacs to produce a sound that consists of a basic “whine” followed by one or more “chucks.” The more chucks he makes, the more likely he is to attract a female; however, his call can also attract predatory bats. The female lays her eggs in floating foam nests in temporary pools.

Leptodactylus pentadactylus

South American bullfrog



Location N. South America



Length 3¼–9 in (8–22 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
Status Least concern

This powerfully built frog is one of the largest members of its genus—a group of 74 species that are mainly confined

to the American tropics. It is yellow or pale brown, with dark markings, long legs, large eyes, and conspicuous external eardrums. The male has muscular forearms, with a sharp black spine on his thumbs, which he uses to fight off other males. The female lays eggs near water, depositing them in a foam nest that the male has created by whipping up mucus with his hind legs. South American bullfrogs are active at night, feeding on insects and other invertebrates as well as other small animals, and spend dry periods hidden under logs or underground. If picked up, they emit a loud scream to startle the predator into loosening its grip. The hind limbs of this frog are sometimes eaten by humans.



smooth, pale skin